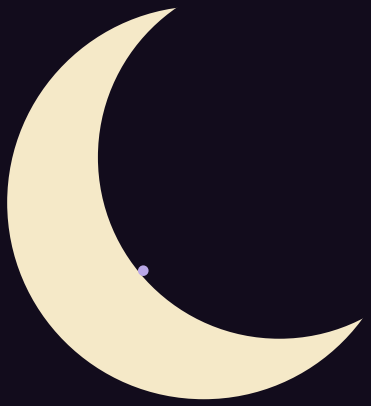
KIROWEEN 2026 | IDEA BOOK



Wilder Ideas

Built on what won Kiroween 2025.

Abbas Rahman & team | volume 2 | 30 October 2026

1 2 3 4 5

THE RESEARCH

What won last year

Kiroween 2025 had 747 projects. These are the winners of the top prizes and categories.

Prize	Project	What it was
Overall 1st	**InteractionKit**	A Skeleton Crew template for gesture-controlled apps (MediaPipe) with hooks, steering and MCP that made Kiro itself reliable at computer vision code.
Overall 2nd	**UnitSet**	A huge Frankenstein design-to-code tool: canvas, AI agent, live sandboxes, visual editor and browser extension in one product.
Overall 3rd	**SpookBnB**	A rental site where toggling dark mode turns it into a flashlight horror escape room.
Best Resurrection + Influencer pick	**Faxi**	Seniors in Japan handwrite a fax; AI reads it, MCP agents act online, and a fax comes back. Judges could fax it themselves.
Best Frankenstein	**rumorNet**	Misinformation detection across 100+ languages with cultural context and bot detection.
Best Skeleton Crew + Most Creative	**Impulse Kit**	A template for fast tap-or-ignore learning games.
Best Costume Contest	**Seance**	A choose-your-path legend book with a striking spooky book UI.
Influencer pick	**BlueKai**	A Bluesky client for KaiOS flip phones.

Patterns behind the wins

- **Make Kiro itself better at something hard.** First place was not an app; it was a kit that turned Kiro into an expert in a tricky domain. Judges score Kiro usage at 20%.
- **Old tech plus agents, and judges can try it for real.** Faxi gave judges a real fax number. Tryable beats impressive-sounding.
- **Scale reads as quality.** UnitSet packed five tools into one coherent product.
- **One clever twist on something familiar.** SpookBnB's dark-mode toggle needs no explanation.
- **Real people with a real problem.** Seniors offline, misinformation, learners.

Already done, so avoid

Haunted portfolios, ELIZA in a terminal, file-cleanup exorcists, typing horror games, instant browser-game generators, haunted house mini-games and "Seance" (the name won Costume Contest last year). Every idea in this volume avoids these; Cursed Cartridge targets real 1989 hardware, not web games.

IDEA 1 | RESURRECTION

CURSED CARTRIDGE

Describe a game out loud and get a real Game Boy cartridge ROM that runs on 1989 hardware.

The idea

Game Boy homebrew is alive but brutal: 8 KB of RAM, a 4-shade screen, tile limits, C or assembly, and toolchains that scare beginners away. Cursed Cartridge is a haunted cartridge workshop. You describe a game, sketch sprites, hum a tune, and a team of agents writes real GBDK C code, packs graphics into tiles, composes chiptune music for the Game Boy sound chip, compiles a genuine .gb ROM and boots it instantly in an emulator in the page. The same file runs on a real Game Boy with a flash cartridge, or on any phone emulator.

What it does

- **Talk-to-ROM:** "a ghost who collects candles in a crypt, gets faster each level" becomes a playable ROM in minutes.
- **Hardware-aware agents:** a designer, a sprite artist, a composer and a compiler agent, each forced to stay inside real hardware limits (tile counts, sprite-per-line limits, memory banks).
- **Sprite seance:** draw on a 4-shade grid or upload any image; it is converted to valid Game Boy tiles and palettes.
- **Chiptune composer:** hum or type a melody and get music for the Game Boy's four sound channels.
- **Cartridge shelf:** every game gets a generated cartridge label and box art, shareable by link, playable by anyone.
- **Learn mode:** step through the generated C code with explanations, a gentle way into low-level programming.

The demo moment

Speak a game idea, watch the agents build it, then play the same ROM on an actual Game Boy held up to the camera.

Build sheet

Stack	Next.js, GBDK-2020 compiler running in a container (or compiled to WebAssembly), an open WebAssembly Game Boy emulator (binjgb or WasmBoy), a canvas sprite editor, Web Audio for chiptune preview.
Free resources	GBDK-2020 (open source), open emulators, public Pan Docs hardware reference, hUGETracker music format, free hosting tiers.
Kiro usage	• Steering docs that encode the hardware limits so every generated line respects them. • Property-based tests: any generated ROM must compile, boot and pass a header checksum. • A custom MCP server that compiles and boots ROMs headlessly so Kiro can check its own output. • A Kiro power that bundles Game Boy expertise for anyone else to reuse.
Why it is heavy	A compiler toolchain, an emulator, asset conversion, music generation and multi-agent code generation for very constrained hardware.
Main risk	Generated code can fail to compile. Build a library of tested game templates first and let agents fill and extend them.

IDEA 2 | COSTUME CONTEST + FRANKENSTEIN

HEARTBEAT

A horror experience that reads your pulse through your webcam and gets scarier the calmer you are.

The idea

Your webcam can see your heartbeat. Tiny color changes in your skin with every pulse can be measured with published, open methods (remote photoplethysmography), no wearable needed. Heartbeat pairs that with blink and gaze tracking and an AI horror director. It watches your body, learns what scares you and adapts the story in real time. Then it flips: the same sensing powers a calm-down trainer that teaches breathing control under pressure, useful for anxiety and exposure practice.

What it does

- **Webcam pulse:** live heart rate from your face, shown as a beating heart in the corner, checked against a phone pulse app in the video.
- **Fear director:** an AI story engine picks the next scene, sound and pacing from your pulse, blinks and where you look.
- **You cannot look away:** if you avoid the screen, the scene notices and waits for you.
- **Fear fingerprint:** at the end, a chart of what spiked your pulse: dark, sound, chase or silence.
- **Calm mode:** a breathing trainer that rewards slowing your pulse during tense scenes, framed as resilience training.
- **Privacy first:** all video stays in the browser; nothing is uploaded.

The demo moment

A volunteer plays while their webcam pulse rises from 72 to 110, the director escalates, and the fear fingerprint appears at the end.

Build sheet

Stack	Web app with MediaPipe Face Mesh, an rPPG algorithm (POS or CHROM) in TypeScript or WebAssembly, Three.js or PixiJS scenes, Web Audio with spatial sound, an LLM story director with structured scene output.
Free resources	MediaPipe, open rPPG methods and the UBFC-rPPG research dataset for testing accuracy, free sound libraries under Creative Commons, open TTS voices.
Kiro usage	• Specs for the signal pipeline with accuracy targets measured on a public dataset. • Property-based tests on signal code: heart rate stays in human range, filters stay stable on noise. • Hooks that re-run the accuracy benchmark whenever signal code changes. • Steering docs for the visual and sound language of every scene.
Why it is heavy	Real biosignal processing, computer vision, an adaptive AI narrative and a polished horror experience in one app.
Main risk	Pulse accuracy drops in bad light. Show a confidence meter and require decent lighting.

IDEA 3 | RESURRECTION + COSTUME CONTEST

TOP 8

The glitter-and-autoplay social web of 2005, resurrected on Bluesky's open protocol, with real people on day one.

The idea

Early social networks let you own your page: custom HTML, a song that autoplayed, a ranked list of your top friends, a guestbook. Then they died and took everything with them. Top 8 brings that era back, but on the AT Protocol behind Bluesky, so it is not a demo: anyone with a Bluesky account signs in and gets a fully customizable profile page instantly, with their real posts and followers. Data lives in their own account, so this time it cannot die.

What it does

- **Your page, your code:** pick a theme or write HTML and CSS in a sandboxed editor; an AI helper styles it from a sentence ("purple goth glitter with rain").
- **Top 8:** rank your friends from your real Bluesky follows, stored as a custom record type on the open protocol.
- **Profile song:** attach a royalty-free track or one you made; a vinyl player spins on your page.
- **Guestbooks and testimonials:** real, federated, stored on the protocol so other apps can read them.
- **Time machine:** import an old export from a dead network and rebuild your page from it.
- **Haunted mode:** once a year the whole network goes Halloween.

The demo moment

A judge signs in with their own Bluesky account and has a glittering custom page with their real friends in a Top 8 in under thirty seconds.

Build sheet

Stack	Next.js, the AT Protocol TypeScript SDK with OAuth sign-in, custom lexicons (record schemas) for Top 8, guestbooks and themes, a sandboxed iframe renderer, an LLM theme generator.
Free resources	AT Protocol and Bluesky public APIs, the Jetstream firehose for live activity, free audio libraries, free hosting tiers.
Kiro usage	• Specs for each custom lexicon, with property-based tests that every record validates against its schema. • Hooks that regenerate TypeScript types whenever a lexicon changes. • An MCP server over the protocol so Kiro can read and write test records while building. • Steering docs for the 2005 design language so generated UI stays consistent.
Why it is heavy	A working social product on a decentralized protocol: OAuth, custom schemas, a sandboxed HTML runtime, live feeds and AI theming.
Main risk	User HTML is a security risk. Render it in a locked-down sandbox with a strict content policy from day one.

IDEA 4 | FRANKENSTEIN

WHISPERS

Friendly ghosts that whisper in 3D sound where obstacles, doors and people are, so blind people can walk with a phone in their pocket.

The idea

Blind and low-vision people navigate with a cane, a dog or expensive devices. A phone camera plus free depth and object models can now map a room in real time, and spatial audio can place a sound exactly where a thing is. Whispers stitches those together: each obstacle becomes a soft voice or tone coming from its real direction and distance, a doorway hums, a chair ticks, a person gets a gentle chime. Ask out loud "where is the exit?" and a guide voice leads you there.

What it does

- **Sound map:** depth from the camera turns into a 3D soundscape through ordinary headphones, updated many times a second.
- **Named spirits:** doors, stairs, chairs, people and vehicles each get their own sound, learnable in minutes.
- **Ask the guide:** a voice assistant that describes the scene, reads signs and leads you to a named target.
- **Stair and drop alarms:** the most dangerous hazards get priority and vibration.
- **Training room:** a playful sighted-mode simulation where friends try it with eyes closed, which also makes a strong demo.
- **Offline by design:** the core loop runs on the device, so it works without signal.

The demo moment

A teammate walks a corridor blindfolded with the phone in a chest pocket, avoids a chair and finds the door, while the video shows what the phone hears.

Build sheet

Stack	Progressive web app, transformers.js with WebGPU running Depth Anything V2 and an open object detector, Web Audio HRTF panning, device motion sensors, an open vision-language model for scene descriptions.
Free resources	Depth Anything V2 small, open detection models, the Web Audio API, open TTS voices, public navigation research for sound design.
Kiro usage	• Specs with hard latency budgets for each stage of the pipeline. • Property-based tests: sound direction always matches object position; hazards always outrank decoration. • Hooks that run a recorded-walk benchmark after every change to measure latency. • Custom agents for model optimization experiments, documented in the write-up.
Why it is heavy	On-device depth estimation, detection, spatial audio and a voice agent running together in real time on a phone.
Main risk	Phone performance. Test early on a mid-range Android and keep a lighter model ready. Make it clear it supports a cane, not replaces one.

IDEA 5 | SKELETON CREW

SUMMONING CIRCLE

A template that makes Kiro brilliant at building AI apps that run entirely in the browser: no server, no API bill, no data leaving the device.

The idea

Browser AI is ready: language models, speech recognition, voices and vision all run locally on WebGPU. But wiring them up is painful, and coding agents hallucinate their APIs. Last year's top prize went to a template that made Kiro reliable in a hard domain. Summoning Circle does that for on-device AI: a lean skeleton with model loading, caching, a worker pipeline and fallbacks, plus steering docs, hooks, an MCP server and a Kiro power that teach Kiro to build these apps without guessing. Two very different apps prove it.

What it does

- **The skeleton:** one clean pattern to load, cache and run any local model in a web worker, with progress UI and graceful fallbacks for weaker devices.
- **App 1, Possessed Objects:** point your camera at a mug or a shoe, it gets eyes and a mouth, a personality and a voice, and talks back. Two objects in frame argue with each other.
- **App 2, 3 AM:** a voice dream journal you speak into half asleep; it transcribes offline, finds patterns across nights and turns each dream into an illustrated page.
- **Kiro power:** bundles the steering docs, hooks and MCP tools so any developer can install it and build their own local AI app.
- **Model doctor:** an MCP tool that tests which models a user's device can run and picks the best fit.

The demo moment

Install the power in a fresh Kiro, ask it for a new local AI app, and it builds one that works first try. Then the talking mug.

Build sheet

Stack	TypeScript, WebLLM or transformers.js on WebGPU, Whisper for speech, Kokoro or another open TTS model, an open vision model, MediaPipe face and object tracking.
Free resources	Open-weight small language models, Whisper, open TTS voices, MediaPipe, free static hosting (no server cost at all).
Kiro usage	• A published Kiro power, the strongest possible proof of deep Kiro understanding. • Steering docs that stop Kiro inventing model APIs, measured before and after. • Hooks that build and smoke-test both apps whenever the skeleton changes. • An MCP server Kiro uses to check model availability and performance while building.
Why it is heavy	A reusable framework, a Kiro power, an MCP server and two complete AI apps that run offline.
Main risk	Models are large to download. Cache aggressively and pick small models for the demo.

SIDE BY SIDE

Comparing the five

Which winning patterns each idea uses, and how hard it is for two people in five weeks.

	Category	Judges can try it	Winning patterns used	Hardest part	Effort
Cursed Cartridge	Resurrection	Play the ROM in the browser	Old tech + agents, Kiro power, scale	Code that always compiles	Very high
Heartbeat	Costume + Frankenstein	Webcam, in the browser	Familiar twist, real problem	Pulse accuracy	High
Top 8	Resurrection + Costume	Sign in with own Bluesky	Old tech revived, real users	Safe user HTML	High
Whispers	Frankenstein	Open on any phone	Real problem, stitched tech	On-device speed	Very high
Summoning Circle	Skeleton Crew	Install the Kiro power	Make Kiro better, two apps	Model sizes	High

Sources

Kiroween 2025 project gallery and winner pages on Devpost (kiroween-2025.devpost.com), and the Kiroween 2026 official rules (kiroween.devpost.com/rules), all read on 30 October 2026.